China without any conditions. This was a 'break point' as, at that moment, the 'Western powers shook ... At first, the OECD countries attacked, saying that the lack of conditions would provoke more corruption. Next, they ran to offer lines of credit not to lose market share for China and others and increasing their action.'[26] However, Angola has recently amended its legislation, establishing a minimum initial level of U$1 million for private investments and imposing the alignment of private investments with the government's goals, whether official or not.[27]

An important characteristic of current international loans in Angola is the use of commodities and raw materials as guarantees for the negotiated credits. It is the so-called 'oil-account.' Therefore, the current Brazilian or Chinese loans do not involve direct conditions concerning macroeconomic and tax policies but rather imply the continuous supply of natural resources. As reported, the BNDES may use in Mozambique the same guarantees adopted in Angola by creating a mechanism of receivables backed by coal.[28] However, up to now, the BNDES's actions in these countries have been small in the face of the magnitude of investments and credit directed towards Africa. Although these actions determine the internationalisation of the Brazilian companies, as mentioned before, they do not constrain the companies' expansion in these countries.

In addition, even if there are no conditions, the macroeconomic and/or tax policies (the traditional credits of the Northern countries) and the credits of the emerging countries (including BNDES) are usually linked to the import and purchase of goods and machinery of the countries granting the credit. With regards to the Chinese credits, they also involve hiring people and, in some cases, carrying out bids in China. As elicited in the interviews, this would be one of the main constraints for its potential development as it would prevent chain effects, technology transfer and training of the local workforce.

So the increase of South–South financial relations has created new forms of indebtedness among the Southern countries, backed by mineral and energy resources. The interviewees pointed out the possible implications of the indebtedness for future generations. This indebtedness can be reinforced with a specific productive route based on primary-export activities and then nullified or minimised with the possibilities of diversification of the productive structure. Moreover, the risk of exhaustion of natural resources (minerals and energy) is apparent in the medium and long term. As commodities, these mineral resources lead to economic instability and are subject to price fluctuations and speculation in the international market, compromising the consolidation of a sustainable